

GSET · NEXT OPERATIONAL ACTIONS · FOR OLLY

20 episodes. One actor. One shoot. Live on 19 June.

A YouTube series of ~20 episodes, ~8 minutes each, cut from the existing audiobook of *The Greatest Story Ever Told*. ~160 minutes of new filming, batched into one shoot. Channel exists. Graphics in flight. This is the operational do-list to get them filmed, edited, and on air.

Prepared by Ted · 13 May 2026 · Post-format-pivot · Channel created

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The five operational workstreams

Everything below sits inside one of these. Nothing else is in scope — no domain, no landing page, no spin-off platforms.

1

Rights

Written permission from Hodder to cut, re-cut and monetise the audiobook on YouTube.

2

Editor

One freelancer on retainer to edit 20 episodes + shorts across the run.

3

Actor

One performer, 20 episodes, single fee, batched shoot.

4

Studio

One London studio booked for a 2-day batch shoot in mid-June.

5

Cost

Year-one budget signed off by Jesse before any commitments are made.

RIGHTS

This week

1

Send the Hodder rights email today

10 min. Email Andy Lyon at Hodder Faith. Ask for written confirmation on:

- Use of audiobook audio in 8-minute YouTube episodes
- Editorial rights to cut chapters into episodes
- **YouTube monetisation of those episodes**
- Use of audio clips for promo shorts

Template is in `gset-operator-playbook.md` Step 1 — add the monetisation line.

Done when: sent. Reply may take a week — don't block other workstreams on it.

2

Confirm where the master audiobook audio lives

Either Hodder has the masters and we license access, or we already have files and need a usage re-license. Ask Andy in the same email: *"How do we get clean audio masters by Mon 9 Jun for the edit?"*

Done when: clear answer on file delivery path and date.

EDITOR

Hire by Fri 23 May

1

Write the editor brief

60 min. Spec the role tight to this format:

- Comfortable layering audiobook audio over picture
- Cuts to 8:30–10:30 mins for YouTube mid-roll monetisation
- Builds shorts (~30–60s) from each episode's offcuts
- Available for ongoing fortnightly cuts after the shoot (run length TBC)
- Retainer £1,500–2,000/mo

Ask Felix who BGV's used before. If nothing usable, post to People Per Hour / Production Hub.

Done when: brief is written, 3+ candidates lined up.

2

Interview 3, hire one

By end of next week. Get a 60-second test edit from each: audiobook audio + any B-roll, their choice. Pick on craft, not pitch.

Done when: contract signed.

ACTOR

Longlist Wed 21 May • sign Fri 30 May

1

Build the longlist (5–6 names)

Criteria:

- Face you can watch for ~3 hours of cumulative screen time across 20 episodes
- Physically and tonally credible for the material
- Available for 2–3 batch shoot days in mid-June
- Single fee covering all 20 episodes + buyout

Mix known and unknown. A recognisable name accelerates launch; an unknown is cheaper and easier to lock in.

Done when: longlist sat in a doc, top 2 contacted.

2

Sign one actor

Decision by Fri 30 May. Budget envelope £2–5k depending on name. **Single-fee buyout** covering all 20 episodes, all platforms, in perpetuity. Don't agree to per-episode fees.

Done when: signed contract in hand.

STUDIO

Book by Fri 6 Jun

1

Get 2–3 quotes for a 2-day batch shoot

London likely. One neutral set, lighting setup once, all 20 chapters back-to-back. Ask Felix for previous BGV studios. Budget envelope **£1.5–3k/day inclusive of crew** (cam op + sound).

Done when: quotes in.

2

Book the studio

Two days: **Tue 16 – Wed 17 Jun** (anniversary 19 Jun, tight against launch). Pay deposit.

Done when: dates locked, deposit paid.

COST

Signed off by Fri 16 May

One message to Jesse with the line items:

LINE	£
Editor retainer (£1.8k/month — total scales with run length, TBC)	1,800/mo
Actor fee + buyout	3,500
Studio (2 days + crew)	4,500
Sound design / mix-in (occasional, post)	1,200
Contingency 10% (on fixed lines)	920
Fixed upfront	~10,120 + editor monthly

Run length / episode cadence still TBC — editor cost is shown as a monthly rate so Jesse can sign off the structure without committing to a length yet. No paid media, no landing page, no domain — none of that is in scope.

RUN-UP

From hires to launch

1

Confirm the chapter map — week of 26 May

Half-page table: ep # → audiobook chapter → timestamp range → working episode title. If chapters don't divide into 8-min units, decide whether to combine or split. Flag to Hodder if it changes the cut materially.

2

Pre-prod with actor — week of 9 June

Read-through, blocking, basic mood per chapter. Half-day with actor + editor + you.

3

Shoot — Tue 16 / Wed 17 June

All 20 chapters in two days. Editor on set day 2 to check footage usability before everyone leaves.

4

Edit ep 1 + trailer in parallel — Wed 17 / Thu 18 June

Editor's only job for 48 hours.

5

Launch — Thursday 19 June 2026

Episode 1 live. 90-sec trailer live. Channel public.

What Ted needs you to decide

1. **Budget envelope to send Jesse:** £10k upfront + £1.8k/mo editor — pitch as structure first, total fills in once you've locked the run length / episode cadence.
2. **Actor route:** known name (faster reach, £4–5k) or unknown (cheaper, £2–3k, takes longer to find the right one)?
3. **Studio:** who do you want me to ask Felix about first — does he have a preferred London studio for a single-set shoot of this kind?

Open questions

- Is there an existing actor relationship we should approach first, or do we go cold?
- Is the audiobook 20 chapters as-is, or are we re-cutting?
- Who is point on Hodder if Andy Lyon goes quiet?

Related: [GSET — Concrete Plan for Jesse \(12 May\)](#) · [Format Pivot \(12 May\)](#)

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